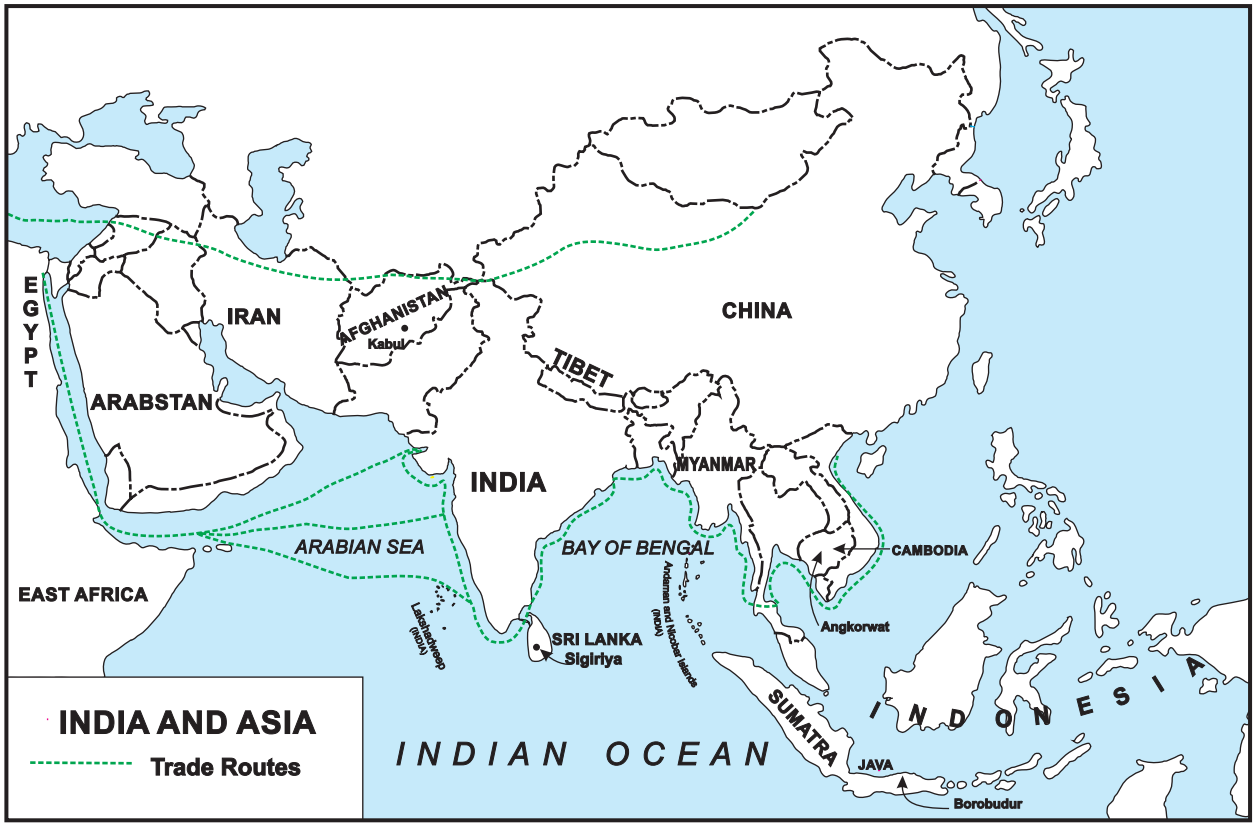

Alexandria was an important port in Egypt. The Arab merchants carried Indian goods up to Alexandria. From there, they were sent to the countries in Europe. Besides Indian goods, the Arabs also conveyed Indian philosophy and science to Europe. The concept of 'zero' is one of India's major contributions to the world. It was the Arabs who introduced this Indian concept to Europe.

11.2 India and other countries in Asia

Many countries in Asia were greatly influenced by the Indian culture of those times.

A wall painting in the Sigiriya caves

Sri Lanka : King Ashoka had sent his son Mahendra and daughter Sanghamitra to Sri Lanka to spread Buddhism. Their names are mentioned in the Buddhist text 'Mahavamsa' written in Sri Lanka. Sanghamitra carried a branch of the Bodhi tree with her. The Sri Lankan tradition believes that the Bodhi tree at Anuradhpur in Sri Lanka has grown from the same branch.

There was a great demand in India for Sri Lankan pearls and other precious stones. In the fifth century CE King Kashyap had caves dug out at a place called 'Sigiriya'. The wall paintings in these caves bear a resemblance to the paintings in the Ajanta Caves. The Sri Lankan Buddhist works 'Dipavamsa' and 'Mahavamsa' provide information about the close relations between India and Sri Lanka. They are written in the Pali language.

China and other countries : Right from the ancient times, India and China had established trade and cultural relations. Emperor Harshavardhan had even sent an ambassador to the Chinese court. Chinese silk was known as '*Chinanshuka*', and was in great demand in India. Merchants in ancient India supplied Chinese silk to western countries. The land route by which the silk trade was carried on, was called the 'Silk Route'. Some ancient places in India were connected to this route. Nala-sopara near Mumbai in Maharashtra was one such place. The Chinese Buddhist *bhikkhus* Fa Hien and Yuan Chwang also came to India through this silk route.

In the first century CE, the Ming Emperor of China invited the Buddhist *bhikkhus* Dharmarakshaka and Kashyapmatanga to China. The *bhikkhus* translated many Indian Buddhist texts into the Chinese language. This gave impetus to the spread of Buddhism in China. Later on, Buddhism also reached Japan, Korea and Vietnam.

Countries in Southeast Asia : The ancient kingdom of 'Funan' in Cambodia was established in the first century CE. Evidence is available from Chinese traditions that an Indian named Kaundinya established it. People of Funan knew the Sanskrit language. A stone inscription of that period is still in existence. It is in Sanskrit. In many other countries of Southeast Asia too, small kingdoms established by people of Indian origin had emerged. These kingdoms helped to spread Indian culture in Southeast Asia.

Indian culture had a deep impact on the art and cultural life of Southeast Asia. Dance-dramas based on stories from the two Indian epics 'Ramayana' and 'Mahabharata' are popular in Indonesia even today. This influence continued to increase over the years. In the ancient period, the Buddhist religion spread to Myanmar, Thailand, Indonesia, etc. In the later years, temples of Lord Shiva and Vishnu were also built there.

This year, we have reviewed Indian history from 3000 BCE to the eighth century CE. Next year, we will study the history of India from the ninth century CE to the eighteenth century CE. The history of this period is known as 'Medieval History'.

Exercise

1. Name the following.

(1) Places where articles made in Rome were found.

(2) A new style of art that emerged during the Kushana period in India.

(3) The language of the books, Mahavansa and Deepvansa.

(4) A country to which Buddhism had spread in the ancient period.

2. Think and expand/elaborate :

(1) Indian culture had an impact on Southeast Asia.

(2) The spread of Buddhism in China became easier.

3. What would you do if you are encouraged in your favourite hobby ?

4. Describe a picture.

A picture of the Gandhara style sculpture on a stupa in Hadda, Afghanistan is given in this chapter. Observe it and write about it.

5. Find out more about –

(1) The Gandhara style of art

(2) The Silk Route

6. Mark the countries of Southeast Asia mentioned in the chapter on an outline map.

Activity :

Obtain information about a form of art of your choice and present it in your class.

* * *

CIVICS

Our Local Government

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English Civics : Standard Six - Learning Outcomes

Suggested Pedagogical Processes	Learning Outcomes
The learner be provided opportunities in pairs/groups/ individually and encouraged to: • participate in discussions on the concepts like diversity, discrimination, the Government, and livelihood. • observe how people are treated fairly/unfairly in family, schools, society, etc. • understand the role of governance in society, and the difference between affairs/events in a family and those of a village/city. • describe case studies of nearby localities/village in the context of occupations. • exercise based on the textbook- to observe functioning of the *Gram Panchayat* or Municipal Council and Municipal Corporation.	**The learner-** 06.73H.13 develops a healthy attitude towards various kinds of diversity around her/ him. 06.73H.14 recognises various forms of discrimination and understands the nature and sources of discrimination. 06.73H.15 differentiates between equality and inequality in various forms to treat them in a healthy way. 06.73H.16 describes the role of the government, especially at the local level. 06.73H.17 identifies various levels of the government – local, state and union. 06.73H.18 analyses the functioning of rural and urban local government bodies in sectors like health and education. 06.73H.19 describes factors responsible for availability of different occupations undertaken in rural and urban areas. 06.73H.20 understands that the society is formed by individuals, families and organisations. 06.73H.21 recognises that secularism is necessary for the national integration. 06.73H.22 identifies that local government body is the foundation of democracy. 06.73H.23 explains that individual participation is essential to solve social problems. 06.73H.24 collects information about the District Administration.

1. Our Life in Society

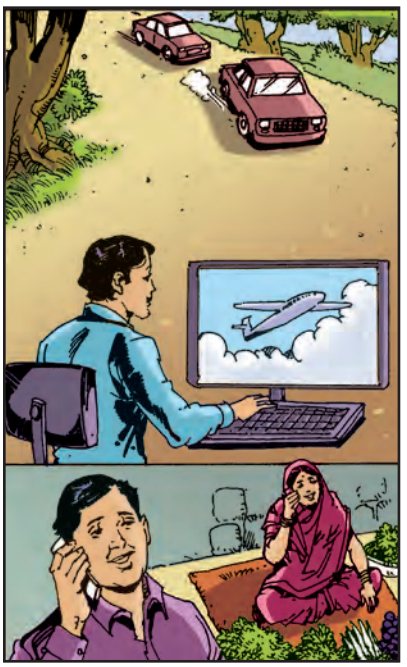
1.1 Why did man feel the need for society ?

1.2 The social nature of man

1.3 Our development

1.4 What is society?

In the fifth standard, you have learnt about the evolution of man. It tells us that our present social life has taken shape through a process of evolution over thousands of years. Man has moved from a nomadic stage to a settled social life.



What will society be like 50 years from now ? Discuss.

1.1 Why did man feel the need for society ?

A stable and secure community life is necessary for the development of the individual as well as society. In the nomadic stage, man did not have this stability and security. When man realized that living in a group provides security, people came together to develop an organized way of life. This was one of the main motivations for the creation of society. Living in society, man felt the need for rules to help with the smooth functioning of day-to-day matters. It gave rise to conventions, traditions, ethics and values, rules and laws. Man's life in society became more organized and stable.

1.2 The social nature of man

Man is social by nature. We all basically like to live with one another, in each other's company and with people around us. Living with people not only makes us happy, it is also our need.

We have many needs. Food, shelter, clothing are our physical needs. Once these are satisfied, man gets a sense of stability, but that is not enough. We also have some emotional and psychological needs. For example, to feel secure is an emotional need. When we are happy, we wish to share our happiness with others. Similarly, when we are sad, we wish to have somebody with us. We like the companionship of our family members, relatives and friends! These feelings reflect our social nature.

Speak and write.

You have got the first prize in a drawing competition. Will you keep it to yourself or show it to your friends? How do you expect them to respond? What were your feelings after their response?

- Felt very happy about the appreciation.
- Felt motivated to draw good pictures.
- (Write more about the feelings you experienced.)

You know that food, clothes, shelter, education and health are our basic needs. Due to the labour and skills of people in the society, a variety of articles are produced. Education and health-related services and facilities allow us to live with dignity. All this is made available in a society. A variety of industries and occupations help to fulfil our needs. For example, we need books for studying; and paper for books. That is why occupations like manufacturing paper, printing, book binding, etc. also develop. Many people contribute to this process. Thus, the variety of occupations in the society help us in fulfilling our needs. This also leads to the development of our skills and capabilities. Our basic needs are fulfilled in society. We depend on each other for our emotional needs such as security, appreciation, praise and support etc. Thus, our life in society is interdependent.

Try this.

Make a list of all the different things we need every day. Who are the people who make these things and help to bring them to you? Find out the answers in relation to at least 5 things you use daily.

1.3 Our development

Every person is born with some qualities and capabilities. But they are dormant. They develop in a society. We use language to communicate with one another, but we cannot do so at birth. We learn language gradually. Our first language is the one that is spoken at home. If our neighbours speak different languages, we pick up those too. Schools also provide opportunities to learn different languages.

We also have the capacity to think independently. For example, when all the students in a class are given the same topic for an essay, why is it that no two essays are the same? It is because the thought process in each is different. Society helps in the development of our emotional capabilities and the power to think. It also provides the opportunity for expressing our thoughts and feelings.

The development of our artistic and other talents also takes place in society. Singers, musicians, artists, scientists, adventurers, social workers can all develop their qualities further because of the backing and encouragement of society. This encouragement is very important.

1.4 What is meant by society?

Society includes all people – men, women, grown-ups, old people, young children. Our families are a part of the society. Society also includes different groups, institutions and organizations. The inter-relationships and inter-actions between the people, their dependence on one another and sharing also form a part of the society. Society is not simply a mob or crowd of people. A society is formed when people come together to achieve certain common objectives.